

SCHOOL OF LIFE FOUNDATION

The Architecture of *Grace*

Scenario Cards — Book 3

Discussion cards for Grades 6–8 across four units — each pairing a real classroom situation with its discussion questions, drawn directly from the Book 3 curriculum. Family-connection and compliance cards travel with the lessons they belong to. Print, cut, and laminate to reuse.

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The Interior · 6–8

Every lesson with scenario cards is represented below. Each card carries a real classroom situation and its discussion questions, drawn directly from the Book 3 curriculum. Family-connection and compliance cards travel with the lessons they belong to.

UNIT 1 The Mask & The Mirror

- Lesson 1 The Mask vs. The Mirror
- Lesson 2 The Anatomy of a Mistake
- Lesson 3 The Digital Backpack
- Lesson 4 Peer Pressure & The Volume of Integrity

UNIT 2 The Internal Critic & The Friend Test

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UNIT 3 Repair & Reckoning

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- Lesson 1 What Is Grace?
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- Lesson 5 Grace With Hard People

 Scenario card  Family connection  Legal · PPRA notice

How to use this deck. Print double- or single-sided on cardstock. Each page holds two cards — cut along the centre line and laminate for reuse. Work scenario cards as a whole class first, then in pairs, following the facilitator note on each card. Send family-connection cards home; observe all PPRA opt-out protocols on flagged lessons.

AMARA

New School, New Mask

Amara transfers to a new school and carefully constructs a social mask — new name spelling, different interests, carefully curated lunch-table conversations. Six months in, she writes in her journal: “I don’t know which one is me anymore.”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What was Amara trying to protect by building the Mask?
- 2 At what point does a protective strategy become a trap?
- 3 What would it cost Amara to show one real thing about herself to one person?
- 4 What is the difference between adapting and disappearing?

FACILITATOR NOTE Use if time allows. Best for classes that engage quickly.

✂ CUT • LAMINATE ✂

JORDAN

The Class Clown

Jordan is the funniest person in every room. Teachers describe him as “a handful.” His closest friend knows Jordan reads philosophy books in private and cries at wildlife documentaries. Jordan has never told anyone what he actually wants to do with his life.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What does the Mask give Jordan? What does it cost him?
- 2 Is Jordan’s humour a Mask, a real part of his identity, or both?
- 3 What would “identity foreclosure” look like for Jordan in five years?
- 4 What’s the smallest step toward letting someone see the Mirror version?

FACILITATOR NOTE Grades 7–8 or faster classes. Introduces identity-fusion concept.

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today we began our identity unit. Ask your child: “Is there a version of you that almost no one gets to see? What would it take to show that version to one safe person?”

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

MAYA

“I Am Stupid”

Maya failed a math test. She tells her friend: “I am just stupid. I’ve always been stupid. There’s no point in trying harder.” She avoids the next test by pretending to be sick.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is Maya experiencing shame or guilt? What evidence supports your answer?
- 2 What is the difference between “I failed the test” and “I am stupid”?
- 3 What does the shame response (avoidance) cost Maya?
- 4 What would a guilt response open up for her?

FACILITATOR NOTE Prioritise this card. Work through as whole class. It illustrates the core distinction most cleanly.

DARIUS

Keeps Paying for It

Darius said something genuinely cruel to a classmate six months ago. He apologized. The classmate forgave him. But Darius still refuses to join group projects, avoids social events, and tells himself he “doesn’t deserve” good friendships.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Darius already did the guilt work (he apologized). What is he doing now?
- 2 What is he protecting himself from by continuing to self-punish?
- 3 If accountability is complete, what does continuing to pay the price achieve?
- 4 What would “self-forgiveness” look like as a practical next step for Darius?

FACILITATOR NOTE Grades 7–8 after Card 1-C debrief. Deepens accountability vs. self-punishment distinction.

✂ CUT • LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today we studied shame vs. guilt. At home: “That was a dishonest choice” (guilt) is more useful than “You are a liar” (shame). Focus on the behaviour, not the person.

COMPLIANCE NOTICE

Opt-Out Protocol

PPRA-DESIGNATED ACTIVITY All standard opt-out protocols apply.

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KEZIA

Perfect Digital Life, Hidden Pain

Kezia's social media shows a confident, happy, social person — beach trips, friend groups, achievements. In reality, Kezia is dealing with significant anxiety and hasn't slept properly in three months. She told a close friend: "If I posted what I actually feel, I'd lose everything."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What is Kezia's digital backpack carrying vs. what is actually in her real backpack?
- 2 Why does the gap between them feel necessary to her?
- 3 What does it cost her to maintain that gap?
- 4 What is the smallest thing she could do to close it — even slightly?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Equity: be sensitive to students from cultures where public display of struggle carries real social consequences.*

MARCUS

Deleted Post, Still Circulating

Marcus posted a heated comment during an argument, regretted it immediately, and deleted it within ten minutes. Fourteen months later, a screenshot of the comment appears during a different conflict. He had no idea it had been saved.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What does this tell us about how the digital environment works?
- 2 Is Marcus responsible for the post even though he deleted it? Why or why not?
- 3 What is the difference between “I deleted it” and “it’s gone”?
- 4 What decision-making filter might Marcus use before posting in the future?

FACILITATOR NOTE Do NOT ask students to share real examples of posts they regret.

✂ CUT • LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students examined their digital footprint. At home: “If someone could only learn about you from your digital presence — what would they know? Would you want that picture to represent you?”

SOFIA

Didn't Stop the Mockery

Sofia's friend group began mocking a quieter classmate at lunch. Sofia didn't join in — but she also didn't stop it. She laughed once when she didn't mean to. Afterwards, she felt sick about it. She told herself: "I'm not a bad person — I just didn't do anything."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What peer pressure mechanism was at work?
- 2 What was the integrity response Sofia did not take?
- 3 What was the smallest possible action she could have taken without major social risk?
- 4 Is "not joining in" the same as "not participating"? Why or why not?

FACILITATOR NOTE Work through all four questions as a whole class first. Do not let students dismiss Sofia as simply weak.

✂ CUT • LAMINATE

GROUP SCENARIO

The Lunch Table Vote

A group of friends is deciding whether to exclude someone from their lunch table going forward. It's framed as a "vote." Most have already said yes. One person hasn't voted yet. That person privately thinks the exclusion is unfair.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What pressure mechanism is being used — and what makes it particularly powerful?
- 2 What are the options available to the person who hasn't voted yet?
- 3 What is the integrity response — and what would it cost?
- 4 What is the difference between loyalty and compliance?

FACILITATOR NOTE Faster classes or debrief extension after Card 1-G. Introduces the "vote" as social coercion mechanism.

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students studied how peer pressure works. At home, share a time you faced peer pressure. What did you do? What do you wish you had done?

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FRIEND TEST · PRIYA

The Essay

Priya worked hard on an essay. She received a C+. She spent the next three days telling herself she was stupid, stopped doing homework for another class, and skipped the teacher's feedback session because "what's the point."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is this an accountability response or self-punishment? How can you tell?
- 2 Apply the Friend Test: what would Priya say to her best friend in this exact situation?
- 3 What does accountability look like here? (acknowledge → repair → commit → move on)
- 4 What is self-punishment costing Priya that accountability would not?

FACILITATOR NOTE Work through as a whole class first, modelling the four accountability steps.

FRIEND TEST · MARCUS

The Argument

Marcus said something cruel to his sister during an argument. She cried. He apologised the same day and she accepted. Two weeks later, Marcus still won't eat dinner with the family, refuses to talk about it, and says: "I'm a terrible person — this is just what I am."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Marcus completed the accountability steps. What is he doing now?
- 2 What is the Friend Test response to Marcus's current self-talk?
- 3 What does it mean that self-punishment continues after accountability is complete?
- 4 What would moving forward actually look like for Marcus?

FACILITATOR NOTE Pairs or small groups after Card 1. Connects to Darius from U1:L2.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students learned the four-step accountability structure: acknowledge · repair · commit · move on. At home, model it: "I made a mistake. Here's what I'm doing about it. Now I'm moving on."

COMPLIANCE NOTICE

Opt-Out Protocol

PPRA-DESIGNATED ACTIVITY All standard opt-out protocols apply.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

FRIEND TEST PAIR · JAMIE

Sports Tryout

Jamie didn't make the team. She had worked harder than anyone she knew. In the week after, she quits the gym, stops eating properly, and tells her mum: "I'm just not athletic. I never will be. It's embarrassing that I even tried."

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Apply the Friend Test: what would Jamie say to her best friend in this situation?
- 2 What is the gap between how Jamie is treating herself and how she would treat someone she cares about?
- 3 Write out Jamie's internal critic statement and then a Compassionate Witness response.
- 4 What does "being on your own side" look like for Jamie right now?

FACILITATOR NOTE Partner A reads the scenario aloud. Partner B applies the Friend Test first. Then swap.

FRIEND TEST PAIR · THEO

The Social Rejection

Theo was not invited to a birthday party that most of his friend group attended. He saw the photos online. He spent the weekend telling himself he was “annoying,” “too much,” and “nobody actually likes me.” He cancelled plans the following week.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is the internal critic’s conclusion (“nobody likes me”) accurate? What evidence would you need to test it?
- 2 Apply the Friend Test: what would Theo say to his best friend making the same conclusion?
- 3 What is the Compassionate Witness response to this situation?
- 4 What is one small action Theo could take that is evidence-based rather than conclusion-based?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Social exclusion is high-frequency for this age group. Do not ask if this resonates personally.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students practised the Friend Test. At home: when your child is being hard on themselves, ask “Would you say that to your best friend?” Then listen.

IMPACT / INTENT · LAYLA & NADIA

The Missed Invitation

Layla forgot to invite her close friend Nadia to a small group hangout — not intentionally, she simply forgot. Nadia found out on social media. She is devastated and tells people Layla “chose to exclude” her. Layla is confused: “I didn’t mean to hurt her — why is she acting like I did this on purpose?”

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What was Layla’s intent? What was the impact on Nadia?
- 2 Does Layla’s good intent make Nadia’s pain less real? Why or why not?
- 3 What does repair address — the intent, the impact, or both?
- 4 What would a repair conversation look like between them?

FACILITATOR NOTE Work through as whole class. Confirm before closing: “Impact is not determined by intent.”

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

IMPACT / INTENT · THEO & AMARA

The Joke That Landed Wrong

During group work, Theo made a joke that the whole group laughed at. One student — Amara — went quiet and didn’t participate for the rest of class. Theo had no idea the joke had a cultural meaning he didn’t know about.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Did Theo intend to target Amara? What was the actual impact?
- 2 Is “I didn’t know” the same as “I didn’t cause harm”?
- 3 What is repair in this situation — and who is responsible for initiating it?
- 4 How does this scenario change if Amara is from an underrepresented group in the class?

FACILITATOR NOTE Equity alert. Do not ask any student to identify whether they have been in Amara’s position.

IMPACT / INTENT · CAMERON

The Group Project

Cameron took over the group project presentation without consulting anyone. The group got a high grade. But two members felt invisible and one told the teacher: “Cameron always does this — he acts like we don’t matter.” Cameron is genuinely surprised — he thought he was helping.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What did Cameron intend? What was the impact?
- 2 Can an action with a positive outcome still cause harm?
- 3 What accountability response is available to Cameron?
- 4 Does the good grade change the answer? Why or why not?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Best for pairs after whole-class Card A debrief. Positive outcomes do not erase harmful impact.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students learned: impact is what repair addresses, regardless of intent. At home: instead of defending intent, try acknowledging impact. “I didn’t mean it that way — and I can see it landed hard. What can I do?”

THREE SIDES · KEZIA & PRIYA

The Broken Friendship

Kezia and Priya were close friends. Priya started a new group of friends and spent less time with Kezia. Kezia told people Priya “abandoned” her. Priya feels Kezia is “too clingy” and was “holding her back.” Both feel misunderstood and hurt.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What is Side One (Kezia’s experience and story)?
- 2 What is Side Two (Priya’s experience and story)?
- 3 What does the Compassionate Observer see that neither of them can?
- 4 Is one side “right”? Can both experiences be real at the same time?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Friendship drift is high-frequency for Grades 6–7. Do not ask if this maps to their own friendships.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

THREE SIDES · MARCUS

The Teacher Complaint

Marcus complained to his parents that his teacher “hates him.” The teacher said Marcus “disrupts class constantly.” A third student in the class sees both — Marcus is often anxious, and the teacher gives harsher feedback to some students than others.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What is Marcus’s side? What is the teacher’s side?
- 2 What does the third student (the Compassionate Observer) see that the two main parties cannot?
- 3 Does the third student’s view mean Marcus has no legitimate grievance?
- 4 What would repair or clarity look like from each of the three positions?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Authority figure on one side — handle carefully.*

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students practised the Three Sides framework. At home: when your child describes a conflict, ask: "What do you think the other person's side was? And what would someone outside the conflict — who cares about both of you — see?"

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FORGIVENESS · DARIUS

The Betrayal

Two years ago, Darius's closest friend shared a private secret with the whole grade. The friendship ended. The friend has since apologised multiple times and is clearly remorseful. Darius has processed the hurt and genuinely no longer carries resentment — but he has no desire to rebuild the friendship.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Has Darius forgiven his friend? How can you tell?
- 2 Is Darius required to reconcile because he has forgiven?
- 3 What is the difference between "I release the resentment" and "I want you back in my life"?
- 4 What would it mean to make forgiveness a condition of reconciliation?

FACILITATOR NOTE Counselor should be present. Do not ask students to share personal forgiveness situations.

FORGIVENESS · HIGH SENSITIVITY

The Family Situation

A student is asked by a well-meaning adult: “Have you forgiven your family member yet? It’s important to forgive.” The student is confused — they don’t feel ready. The family member has not apologised or changed the harmful behaviour.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is forgiveness appropriate here? What information would you need to decide?
- 2 What is the difference between forgiving someone who is still causing harm vs. someone who is not?
- 3 Is it ever okay to NOT forgive?
- 4 What would you say to the well-meaning adult about the pressure to forgive?

FACILITATOR NOTE HIGH SENSITIVITY. Do NOT use if a student is in a known ongoing harmful family situation.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students learned one of the most important distinctions of the year: forgiveness and reconciliation are not the same thing. Your child does not have to resume a relationship to forgive. Please reinforce this at home.

HIGH RISK ACTIVITY

Counselor Required

PPRA-DESIGNATED ACTIVITY HIGH RISK. Counselor on-site required. Mandatory same-day counselor brief after this lesson.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

DIGITAL ECHO · LAYLA

The Screenshot

Layla sent a private message venting about a conflict with a classmate. Her friend showed the screenshot to three others. By the next morning it had been shared widely. Layla's first instinct was to post a detailed public response defending herself.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What happens if Layla posts the public response immediately — walk through the echo chain.
- 2 What is the difference between react and respond here?
- 3 What information does Layla need before doing anything?
- 4 What is the minimum effective response — the smallest action that addresses the harm without amplifying it?

FACILITATOR NOTE *The “minimum effective response” is the key concept. De-escalation is strategic, not weakness.*

DIGITAL ECHO · GROUP SCENARIO

The Group Chat

A group chat begins mocking a student not in the chat. Someone screenshots and sends it to the student being mocked. The student responds. The original poster escalates. Now it's spread to a larger group.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 At what point could someone have interrupted this chain?
- 2 What would RESPOND (not REACT) look like at each stage?
- 3 What does "audience collapse" look like in this scenario?
- 4 If you were in the group chat watching this happen, what is one specific thing you could do?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Equity note: consider who is most likely to be the person mocked.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

DIGITAL ECHO · PUBLIC ACCOUNTABILITY

The Callout Post

Someone posted publicly calling out a classmate by name for something they did six months ago. The post has been liked and shared. The classmate has not responded. A third student who witnessed the original incident knows the callout post is partially inaccurate.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What are the three available responses for the classmate being called out?
- 2 What is the third student's responsibility — if any?
- 3 Does the partial inaccuracy of the callout change what the right response is?
- 4 What would "minimum effective response" look like for each person?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Grades 7–8. Public accountability vs. public attack.*

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students studied digital conflict and the Flame vs. Pause framework. At home, model the pause before responding online: “Let me think about what I actually want to happen before I say anything.”

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

BOUNDARY · SOFIA

The Pressure Loop

Every time Sofia says she doesn't want to do something, her friend group applies the same pressure: “You're being so boring. You used to be fun. Don't you trust us?” She always gives in to end the discomfort.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What limit does Sofia need to set — and what value does it protect?
- 2 Write a boundary script using the formula: “When you ___ / I ___ / Going forward, I need ___.”
- 3 What is the difference between this limit and retaliation against her friends?
- 4 What happens to Sofia's identity if she never sets this limit?

FACILITATOR NOTE Connects to U1·L4 peer pressure. Students who remember the Integrity Statement should recognise this as values-in-action.

BOUNDARY · MARCUS

The Oversharer

Marcus has a friend who shares Marcus's private information with others — not maliciously, just carelessly. Marcus has hinted that he doesn't like it. The friend doesn't pick up on the hints and keeps doing it.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Why have hints not worked? What does a clear limit look like instead?
- 2 Write a boundary script for Marcus to deliver directly to his friend.
- 3 What value is Marcus protecting with this limit?
- 4 What does Marcus lose if he never sets this limit clearly?

FACILITATOR NOTE *The shift from hinting to direct communication is key for this age group.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students practised setting boundaries as acts of self-respect. At home, model boundary-setting and name it: "I am setting a limit on that because I need to take care of myself."

GRACE • NADIA

The Unexpected Kindness

Nadia had been excluded by her friend group for three weeks. On a particularly bad day, a classmate she barely knew sat next to her at lunch — not because anyone told him to. He just noticed. He didn't say anything about the exclusion. He just sat there.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Was this grace? What makes it grace rather than just politeness?
- 2 What did it cost the classmate? What did Nadia receive?
- 3 Why does grace that costs something feel different from grace that doesn't?
- 4 What would have to be true about the classmate's character for this to happen naturally?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Opening card for grace definition. The "cost" element is key.*

✂ CUT • LAMINATE ✂

GRACE • MARCUS

The Second Chance

Marcus was removed from the school play after a serious mistake in rehearsal. The drama teacher — who had every right to keep him out — quietly invited him back two weeks later with one condition: "Show me with your actions, not your words." Marcus never missed another call.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Was the teacher's action grace, mercy, or both?
- 2 What did the single condition add to the grace? Would it be grace without the condition?
- 3 What does "show me with your actions" do to Marcus's relationship with the second chance?
- 4 What does this tell us about the difference between grace and having no standards?

FACILITATOR NOTE *"The condition is not punishment — it is dignifying expectation."*

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME We began our final unit — Grace and Generosity — today. Ask your child: “What does grace look like in your world right now? Have you seen it this week?”

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

MERCY · PRIYA & JAMIE

The Overdue Apology

A year ago, Priya publicly embarrassed Jamie during a class presentation. She didn't apologise until recently. The apology was genuine. Jamie is in a position to exclude Priya from a group project that Priya really needs — and Jamie has every social right to do so.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is mercy appropriate here? What would it look like?
- 2 What would justice require? Can Jamie have both mercy and justice?
- 3 What does mercy cost Jamie — and what might it give Priya?
- 4 Does the late apology change what mercy is worth here?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Whole-class model card. The mercy-justice tension is the destination — do not resolve it.*

MERCY · THEO

The Repeated Mistake

Theo keeps making the same mistake — arriving late to group rehearsals. He is genuinely remorseful each time. His group is deciding whether to ask him to leave. They have given him two chances already.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is a third chance mercy — or is it enabling a pattern?
- 2 What is the difference between mercy and having no accountability?
- 3 What would mercy WITH a clear condition look like here?
- 4 At what point does mercy become unfair to everyone else?

FACILITATOR NOTE Pairs after whole-class Card A. The “mercy as enabling” question is developmentally important.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

MERCY · EQUITY

The Power Difference

A teacher had the power to fail a student for an assignment that was late due to a documented family crisis. Instead, they accepted it without penalty. The student never asked — the teacher just quietly decided.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Is this mercy? What makes it mercy rather than just rule-breaking?
- 2 How does power difference change what mercy means — and what it costs?
- 3 Equity: is this mercy available equally to all students?
- 4 What does this tell us about who gets to be merciful — and why that matters?

FACILITATOR NOTE Equity alert — mercy is not equally distributed.

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students studied mercy. At home, look for a mercy moment this week and name it: "I am choosing to extend some mercy here."

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

CHARITABLE READING · LAYLA

The Ignored Message

Layla sent a message to a close friend and got no reply for two days. Her first interpretation: "She's ignoring me. She's mad. I must have done something." A week later, she finds out her friend's grandmother had been hospitalised.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What was the negative interpretation? What did it cost Layla in that week?
- 2 What is the charitable interpretation? How available was it before Layla knew the truth?
- 3 Apply The Pause: what would each of the four steps have looked like here?
- 4 Does practising charitable interpretation mean you're always right? What does it give you even when you're wrong?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Whole-class model. The Pause steps should be worked through explicitly.*

CHARITABLE READING · CAMERON & NADIA

The Short Answer

During group work, Cameron gave a short, flat answer when Nadia tried to include him. Nadia interpreted it as: “He thinks I’m annoying.” Cameron was actually anxious about presenting and barely heard the question.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What negative interpretation did Nadia form? What does it lead her to do next?
- 2 What is the charitable interpretation?
- 3 What is the smallest action that tests the charitable interpretation rather than acting on the negative one?
- 4 How does this change if Cameron often gives short answers to Nadia specifically?

FACILITATOR NOTE *Final question is important — charitable interpretation has limits when a pattern is clearly directed at one person.*

✂ CUT · LAMINATE ✂

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students practised charitable interpretation. At home, model the pause: “That could mean a few different things. What is another explanation besides the obvious one?”

HARD PEOPLE · PRIYA

The Persistent Critic

Every time Priya contributes in class, a classmate makes a dismissive comment — a small eye roll, a quiet sigh, a one-word rebuttal. It happens consistently. Priya finds this person irritating and demoralising, but there is no physical threat and no ongoing harassment outside class.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 Where does this person fall on the difficult-to-unsafe spectrum?
- 2 Is grace the goal here, or is safety?
- 3 What does grace look like in this situation — specifically?
- 4 What would grace NOT look like? What is grace NOT asking Priya to accept?

FACILITATOR NOTE Whole-class model. Final question is critical — grace is not acceptance of mistreatment.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE

HARD PEOPLE · TWO STUDENTS

The Complicated History

Two students have a history — one hurt the other significantly two years ago. They are now in the same class. The student who was hurt has done their own processing. Now they notice the other student struggling socially and isolated. They don't want to be friends again — but they feel something.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

- 1 What is that feeling? Is it grace — or something else?
- 2 Is there a gracious posture available that does NOT require rebuilding the relationship?
- 3 What is the difference between “I want good things for you” and “I want to be close to you again”?
- 4 What would the smallest possible act of grace look like — if any?

FACILITATOR NOTE Builds on U3·L3 (forgiveness without reconciliation). Grace-at-a-distance is the key takeaway.

FOR CAREGIVERS

A Note Home

TO BRING HOME Today students studied grace toward difficult people. The curriculum is clear: grace is not required toward people who are unsafe. We practise grace toward people who are merely difficult. That is a meaningful distinction.

✂ CUT · LAMINATE